America's plans for a missile defense system were opposed by both Russia and China (Ambrosio 2007). These incidents made Russia build alternative power centers in global politics so that Russia could constrain the West's influence on Russia and in international politics.

Jiang Zemin, the then-China president, officially incorporated multipolarity (duojishijie) into Chinese foreign policy during the 14th Congress of the Communist Party of China in 1992. This supported China's stance that a fair, just, and peaceful world was possible only through multipolarity (Lo 2008). In 1997, Chinese President Jiang Zemin and Russian President Boris Yeltsin released a 'Joint Declaration on Multipolar World and the Formation of a New International Order' (Lo 2002). Since then, the efforts of these two countries have been to construct a new world order continuously. In 2000, Russia incorporated multipolarity in its foreign policy. 'Russia has two things to focus on now, strengthening a political and economic situation of it … and multilateral governance in the international system. It would strive to create a multipolar world order' (National Security Concept of Russian Federation 2000). Since Jiang's leadership, Chinese foreign policy has acknowledged that a singular and unchecked superpower can be very dangerous, as exemplified by the US invasion of Iraq without any UN sanction and the US/NATO actions in Kosovo (Grace Guerrero 2011). The China–Russia 1997 Joint Statement strongly emphasized that a fair and just society could only be possible in a multipolar world and not in a unipolar one.

Furthermore, on March 26, 2007, Putin said during the opening ceremony of the year of China in Russia that Russia and China both share several positions in the international arena and are driven by the same goals. 'Our efforts are to maintain and strengthen the principles of the multipolar setup to preserve the strategic balance in the world' (Kremlin 2007). Russian foreign minister, Sergey Lavrov (2012), wrote an article titled 'International Affairs' and underlined that the BRICS country's influence stems from Russian and Chinese inclusion in the UN Security Council. And also, all its remaining members of the BRICS group are the members of the leading international organizations and entities such as the United Nations, G-20, the Non-Alignment, and the group of 77. At the same time, these countries are also key players in critical regional organizations. Russia is a member of CIS,[17] CSTO,[18] and the EurAsEC.[19] Russia and China are